Respond to microaggressions and difficult moments

Teaching

WHAT IS THIS FOR?

Prepare simple ways to protect participation when a comment or interaction makes the learning environment less safe.

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Prepare simple ways to protect participation when a comment or interaction makes the learning environment less safe.

WHAT DOES THIS LOOK LIKE?

There are clear expectations for respectful participation, and harmful comments or microaggressions are addressed rather than left for affected students to manage.

WHAT CAN I DO?

- Do not leave a harmful comment completely unaddressed.
- Name the issue without turning the class into a trial of the person who spoke.
- Reconnect the response to the class norms and learning purpose.
- Follow up privately where extra support or repair is needed.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

An educator briefly names a stereotyped comment, explains why the assumption is problematic, recentres the discussion and follows up after class.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For the next teaching period, our team will: do not leave a harmful comment completely unaddressed; name the issue without turning the class into a trial of the person who spoke. We will review student feedback and adjust if needed.

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UQ teaching practices

Students as Partners

Inclusive practice